

KENNY T. PHAN

✉ kenny.phan@yale.edu in linkedin.com/in/kenny-thai-phan 🌐 kenny-phan

EDUCATION

Yale College

Jun 2023 – May 2027

B.S. Astrophysics, Certificate in Intensive Education Studies (in progress); 3.6/4

- **Student Employment:** Student Accessibility Assistant (Oct 2023 – May 2024)
- **Academic Societies:** Sigma Pi Sigma

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UC Berkeley SETI Research Center

Berkeley, CA

PI: James Davenport

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Project Title: Searching Nearby Stars for Lasers Using CARMENES Spectroscopy

Yale Department of Astronomy

New Haven, CT

PI: Malena Rice

May 2024 – Present

- Analyzed data from TESS and HST to understand atmospheric variability on Neptune and Uranus
- Devised equation to relate variability in brightness to the circulation of surface features
- Results in prep for first-author publication

Universidad de Chile Department of Astronomy

Santiago, Chile

PI: Patricio Rojo

May 2025 – Jul 2025

- Analyzed CRIRES+ exoplanet spectra with a Principal Component Analysis-based [pipeline](#)
- Confirmed absence of an atmosphere on super-Earth GJ 486b

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS ([†]*invited*)

K. T. Phan, P. Rojo. “CRIRES+ Corroborates No Thick Atmosphere on GJ 486b.” ExoNYC, February 2026 [10-minute talk]

K. T. Phan, P. Rojo. “CRIRES+ Corroborates No Thick Atmosphere on GJ 486b.” Dynamical Synthesis of Planetary Systems, January 2026 [12-minute talk][†]

K. T. Phan, P. Rojo. “CRIRES+ Corroborates No Thick Atmosphere on GJ 486b.” High-Resolution Spectroscopy for Exoplanet Atmospheres Workshop, December 2025 [Poster]

K. T. Phan, M. Rice. “Light Curve Analysis of the Ice Giants via TESS.” NASA Connecticut Space Grant Consortium Fall 2025 Grants Expo, November 2025. [Poster]

K. T. Phan, M. Rice. “Neptune’s Atmospheric Features Inferred from TESS Photometry.” 56th Lunar & Planetary Science Conference, March 2025. <https://www.hou.usra.edu/meetings/lpsc2025/pdf/2734.pdf> [10-minute talk]

K. T. Phan, M. Rice. “Resolving Weather Features on Neptune with TESS.” CT Exoplanet Picnic, July 2024. [1-minute lightning talk]

K. T. Phan, M. Rice. “Weather on Neptune.” Yale Summer Research Symposium, July 2024. [15-minute talk]

GRANTS & AWARDS (\$50.5k+ total, \$32.5k+ undergrad)

UC Berkeley Breakthrough Listen Stipend (\$12,538)	2026
Yale James A. Helzer Travel Grant (\$500) ×2	2025
Yale Summer Experience Award (\$3k)	2025
Yale George Schultz Summer Fellowship in the Natural Sciences (\$4.5k)	2025
Yale Alan S. Tetelman 1958 Fellowship for International Research in the Sciences (\$7.5k, rescinded due to excess funds)	2025
LPSC/LPI Dwornik Award Honorable Mention, Undergraduate Oral Presentation	2025
LPSC/LPI Travel Stipend (\$500)	2025

NASA CTS GC Undergraduate Research Grant (\$6k)	2024 – 2025
Yale First-Year Summer Research Fellowship in the Sciences & Engineering (\$5k)	2024
The Gates Scholarship	2023 – 2027
Asian Pacific Islander American/FedEx Scholarship (\$10k)	2023 – 2027
Elks National Foundation Most Valuable Student Semifinalist (\$4k)	2023 – 2027
Isaac Bruce Foundation Flight 300 Program ×3	2023, 2024, 2025
Elks National Foundation Washington State Scholar (\$2k)	2023 – 2024
Princeton Prize in Race Relations National Certificate of Accomplishment	2023
InpirASIAN Washington State Awardee (\$1k)	2023
Leadership Enterprise for a Diverse America Scholar	2022
YLC Young Leaders Summit Scholar	2022
QuestBridge College Prep Scholar; STEM Award (\$1k)	2022

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Yale Prison Education Initiative	<i>New Haven, CT</i>
<i>Peer Tutor</i>	2026
◦ Peer tutor for 10 incarcerated students in college math	
Splash @ Yale	<i>New Haven, CT</i>
<i>Instructor</i>	2025
◦ Taught 1-hour introductory courses on astrobiology and exoplanets to a total of 60 students	
◦ Courses: Where are the Aliens? ×2, Exoplanets and How to Find Them, How to Talk to Aliens	
Various Organizations	<i>New Haven, CT; Los Angeles, CA</i>
<i>College Mentor</i>	2023 – 2025
◦ Orgs: Leadership Enterprise for a Diverse America, Youth Leadership Consortium, New Haven REACH	
◦ Edited essays, advised on applications for 10+ first-generation/low-income students, always free of charge	
◦ Mentee admitted schools and programs: Columbia, Penn State, Duke, University of Washington, The Gates Scholarship, QuestBridge College Match Finalist	

Skills

Languages: Spanish (2 years, high school), Vietnamese (1.5 years, college)

Programming: Python, C/C++, Mathematica, Java, R